

Interview ID: INT-01

Expert type: Window supplier

Name or anonymised role: Anonymised window supplier

Organisation: Anonymised company

Date: 16/06/2026

Duration: 20 minutes

Format: Phone

Permission to use anonymised notes: Yes

Interview purpose:

This interview collects practical knowledge about common window failures, repair possibilities, spare-part availability, replacement decisions, reuse barriers and information that could help architects make better component-lifecycle decisions.

Consent note:

The participant gave permission for anonymised or paraphrased insights to be used in the project: Yes

Q1. Which window components usually fail first in residential window systems? / Кои компоненти на жилищната дограма обикновено се повреждат или износват първи?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Според интервюирания специалист, най-често първо се повреждат или износват обковът, механизмите за отваряне и дръжките. След тях като проблемен компонент могат да се появят и стъклопакетите.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier identified hardware, opening mechanisms and handles as the components most likely to fail or wear first. Glazing units were mentioned as another possible problem area after the hardware. This suggests that many early failures occur in shorter-life components rather than in the full frame system.

Relevant codes:

Physical obsolescence / Technical obsolescence / Maintenance / Component replacement

Q2. Which failures can usually be repaired without replacing the complete window? / Кои повреди обикновено могат да се ремонтират без да се подменя целият прозорец?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Обикновено могат да се ремонтират или подменят обковът, дръжките и стъклопакетите, без да се налага цялостна подмяна на прозореца.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier stated that hardware, handles and glazing units can usually be repaired or replaced without replacing the whole window. This directly supports the idea that component-level repair and replacement can extend the useful life of the window system when access and compatible parts are available.

Relevant codes:

Repair / Component replacement / Component accessibility / Maintenance

Q3. What prevents repair when repair is technically possible? / Какво най-често пречи да се направи ремонт, дори когато технически ремонтът е възможен?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Основна пречка е липсата на достъп до определени елементи. Специалистът посочи, че когато прозорците са обърнати или завършени неправилно, може да няма достатъчен достъп до пантите, механизмите или други части, които трябва да бъдат обслужени или ремонтирани.

English explanation / interpretation:

The main barrier is not necessarily the technical impossibility of repair, but poor access to the components that need servicing. If the window reveal or finishing is poorly executed, it may become difficult to reach hinges, mechanisms or other serviceable parts. This is an implementation gap: the window may be repairable in theory, but not easily repairable in practice.

Relevant codes:

Component accessibility / Repair information / Missing repair infrastructure / Skilled labour / Implementation gap

Q4. How long are compatible spare parts normally available? / Обикновено за колко време са налични съвместими резервни части за дадена прозоречна система?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Специалистът посочи, че проблеми с резервните части се появяват основно при много стари прозорци, например системи на около 25 или повече години. При такива случаи може да бъде по-трудно да се намерят напълно съвместими части.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier suggested that spare-part availability becomes a more serious issue for very old window systems, especially around 25 years or older. In these cases, compatible components may be harder to

find. This supports the idea that long-term repairability depends not only on design, but also on supplier support and continued availability of compatible parts.

Relevant codes:

Spare parts / Supplier commitment / Implementation gap / Technical obsolescence

Q5. Why do clients choose full replacement instead of repair or maintenance? / Защо клиентите често избират цялостна подмяна вместо ремонт, настройка или поддръжка?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Клиентите често избират цялостна подмяна, защото искат нова, по-добра, по-дебела и по-модерна дограма. Решението не винаги е свързано само с това дали ремонтът е възможен, а и с желанието за по-нова и по-съвременна система.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier explained that clients often choose full replacement because they want a newer, thicker, better or more modern window system. This means that replacement decisions are not only technical. They are also influenced by expectations, perceived improvement, aesthetics and the desire for a more contemporary product. This may lead to premature replacement even when repair is possible.

Relevant codes:

Premature replacement / User acceptance / Aesthetic obsolescence / Functional obsolescence / Economic obsolescence

Q6. Can modularity or replaceable parts create extra cost, material use, technical complexity or maintenance problems? / Могат ли модулността или сменяемите части да създадат допълнителни проблеми, например по-висока цена, повече материал, техническа сложност или по-трудна поддръжка?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Според интервюирания специалист, цената може да варира спрямо пазара и цените на материалите. Например, ако се повиши цената на желязото или други материали, това се отразява върху крайната цена. Той не посочи, че сменяемите части сами по себе си водят до повече материал, техническа сложност или по-трудна поддръжка.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier connected cost mainly to market conditions and material prices rather than to modularity itself. He did not identify replaceable parts as a direct cause of additional material use, technical complexity or more difficult maintenance. This is useful because it partly contrasts with the literature, where modularity and component replaceability can sometimes introduce additional complexity or material burden.

Relevant codes:

Economic obsolescence / Higher initial material use / Lifecycle trade-off / User acceptance

Q7. What prevents removed windows or window components from being reused? / Какво най-често пречи свалени прозорци или отделни компоненти от дограма да бъдат използвани повторно?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Основна пречка са специфичните размери на прозорците, тъй като те обикновено са изработени за конкретен отвор и трудно могат да бъдат използвани директно в друг проект. При рециклиране не всички компоненти могат да се използват повторно като компоненти. Специалистът посочи, че стъклата са един от малкото елементи, които потенциално могат да се използват, но и те стареят.

English explanation / interpretation:

The main barrier to direct reuse is the project-specific size of windows. Because windows are usually made for a specific opening, they are difficult to reuse directly in another project. The supplier also noted that not all components can realistically be reused after removal, and that even glass has ageing-related limitations. This supports the distinction between theoretical reuse potential and practical reuse feasibility.

Relevant codes:

Direct reuse / Disassembly / Service infrastructure / Certification / Technical obsolescence / Recycling

Q8. Which design decision most strongly influences future repairability? / Кое проектно или техническо решение според Вас най-силно влияе върху бъдещата ремонтпригодност на дограмата?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Най-важното условие е да бъде осигурен лесен достъп до компонентите. Специалистът подчерта значението на правилното обръщане и завършване около прозореца, така че при бъдеща нужда да може да се достигне до пантите, обкова и други части за ремонт или настройка.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier identified component access as the most important design-related factor for future repairability. Correct detailing and finishing around the window are essential because they determine whether hinges, hardware and other serviceable parts can be reached later. This directly links architectural detailing to long-term maintenance and repair outcomes.

Relevant codes:

Design intervention / Component accessibility / Repair information / Maintenance planning

Q9. Have you seen a supposedly sustainable window decision create an unexpected problem later? / Виждали ли сте решение, което първоначално изглежда устойчиво или енергийно ефективно, но по-късно създава неочакван проблем?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Специалистът не посочи конкретен пример за решение, което първоначално е изглеждало устойчиво или енергийно ефективно, но по-късно е създадо неочакван проблем.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier did not provide a direct example of a sustainable or energy-efficient window decision creating an unexpected problem later. This should be treated as an absence of evidence from this interview, not as proof that such problems do not occur. For the project, this means that the interview supports practical repair and access issues more strongly than rebound or unintended-consequence examples.

Relevant codes:

No direct example / General unintended consequence not identified

Q10. What information would help architects make better decisions about window repair, replacement, service life and environmental impact? / Каква информация би помогнала на архитектите да взимат по-добри решения относно ремонт, подмяна, експлоатационен живот и екологично въздействие на дограмата?

Answer notes in Bulgarian:

Според специалиста най-важно за архитектите е да предвидят добър достъп до дограмата и нейните компоненти. Ако достъпът е добре решен, много от елементите могат да бъдат ремонтирани или обслужени. Интервюираният не предостави конкретна информация относно експлоатационния живот или екологичното въздействие на дограмата, което само по себе си показва информационна празнина между практическата ремонтпригодност и екологичната оценка.

English explanation / interpretation:

The supplier emphasised that architects should ensure good access to the window and its components. From his perspective, good access makes repair and servicing much more realistic. However, he did not provide specific information about environmental impact or verified service life. This suggests a gap between practical repair knowledge and lifecycle-based environmental information available to architects.

Relevant codes:

Component accessibility / Repair information / Lifecycle verification / Design intervention / Implementation gap

Additional notes from the interview:

The interview mainly focused on practical repairability, access to components, spare parts and client decision-making. It did not provide detailed environmental data or quantified service-life information.

Key takeaways:

Component accessibility is the strongest practical enabling condition identified in the interview.

Hardware, handles and glazing units are the main components that can often be repaired or replaced without replacing the full window.

Full replacement is often driven by client preference for a newer, thicker or more modern system, not only by technical failure.

Direct reuse is limited by project-specific window dimensions and ageing components.

The supplier had practical knowledge about repair and replacement, but limited information about lifecycle environmental impact.

Possible MAXQDA codes:

Component accessibility / Repair / Component replacement / Spare parts / User acceptance / Premature replacement / Technical obsolescence / Direct reuse / Recycling / Implementation gap / Lifecycle verification / Design intervention

Useful quote or paraphrase:

“If there is good access, then many things can be repaired.”

Follow-up needed:

No, unless further clarification is needed on spare-part availability or typical glazing replacement practices.

Short post-interview summary:

This interview shows that the practical repairability of residential windows depends strongly on access to components, especially hinges, mechanisms, handles and glazing units. The supplier's answers suggest that repair is often technically possible, but can be limited by poor detailing around the window, lack of access, very old systems, unavailable compatible parts and client preference for newer or more modern products. The interview also highlights a gap between practical repair knowledge and lifecycle or environmental information: the supplier could discuss failures and repair access clearly, but did not provide specific evidence about service life or environmental impact.